

Harikrishna Pala

+1-737-336-0617 | haripala@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Windows, VMware, Cloud Engineer with a strong background in infrastructure. Proficient in designing and implementing reliable and scalable environments across VMware, AWS and Azure platforms. Successfully led the development and migration of complex AWS and Azure infrastructures, improving system scalability and reliability. Expertise in configuring and optimizing cloud services through advanced scripting for seamless automation and integration. Committed to leveraging deep technical knowledge and strategic insight to design and enhance cutting-edge system solutions. Proficient in VMware vSphere, ESXi, vCenter, oVirt, KVM. Strong expertise in troubleshooting complex virtualization issues, optimizing performance, and providing advanced L3 support to ensure seamless operation of virtual infrastructure. Experienced in managing critical infrastructure services such as DHCP, DNS, Microsoft 365, Exchange, and Entra ID (Azure AD). Strong expertise in troubleshooting complex virtualization issues, optimizing performance, and providing advanced L3 support to ensure seamless IT operations. Adept at leading migrations, upgrades, and cross-functional collaboration across VMware, open-source virtualization platforms, enterprise applications and on-prem to cloud migration projects

Core Skills

Cloud Computing: AWS (ECS, EC2, VPC, S3, RDS, ELB, Lambda, CloudFormation, CloudTrail), Azure (VMs, VNET, AD, AAD-DS), Oracle Cloud (Virtual Machines, DNS, Load Balancers), Azure Administration, Oracle Cloud Administration, Azure DevOps, Azure Security, Azure Networking.

Active Directory: Implementing, managing, and integrating AD services (AD DS, ADS, AD CS) in on-premises and AWS environments.

Core Infrastructure: DHCP, DNS, Group Policy, Active Directory (On-prem & Entra ID/Azure AD).

Messaging & Collaboration: Microsoft 365 Administration, Exchange Online & On-Prem, Hybrid Exchange Environments

On-prem to Cloud Migration: Expertise in strategizing, planning, and executing seamless migrations from on-premises environments to cloud platforms such as AWS and Azure.

Server Hardware Expertise: Extensive experience with Dell PowerEdge (R740, R650, R730) and HP ProLiant (DL380, DL360, ML350) servers.

Lifecycle Management: Firmware updates, RAID configuration, and hardware replacement for Dell and HP servers.

Infrastructure Automation: Automation using PowerShell, Ansible for repetitive tasks and reporting.

Operating System: Windows servers, RedHat Linux, CentOS and Ubuntu.

Virtualization Tools: VMware ESXi, vCenter, vRA, Nutanix AHV, Prism Central, oVirt, KVM, libvirt, virt-manager.

Patching Tools: Patch management WSUS, SCCM and BigFix

Monitoring and Maintenance: Experience with Dell OpenManage Enterprise, Secure Connect Gateway, and tools like SolarWinds, Datadog, Splunk, Infoblox and Nagios.

Security & Compliance: Vulnerability remediation (Rapid7/MVM/Qualys).

Additional Capabilities: Team management, Remote Desktop configuration on Azure VMs, Third-party application support.

Certifications

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate: YKLZ3YCC2FRE1YC

ITIL V3 Foundation Certified: from Exin

VMware Certified Associate - Data Center Virtualization: (VCA-DCV)

Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator: MCP in Windows 2003/2008

Microsoft Exchange Server 2010: (Configuration)

Microsoft Certified Professional: (ID: 5742480)

Education

India

Bachelor's, computer science

Professional Experience

AMD Inc

Jul 2016 – Present

MTS Systems Engineer

- Designed, deployed, and managed VMware and oVirt environments while maintaining DHCP, DNS, and AD-integrated services.
- Troubleshoot and resolved advanced issues with vSphere, oVirt/KVM, DNS records, and M365 services, ensuring business continuity.

- Automated user provisioning, VM deployments, and infrastructure monitoring using PowerShell, PowerCLI, and Ansible.
- Migrated workloads between VMware and oVirt environments, including M365 mailbox migrations, DNS zone transfers, and on-prem to cloud migrations to AWS and Azure.
- Configured high-availability clusters for VMware, ensuring zero service downtime for critical systems.
- Worked with Entra ID (Azure AD) to implement hybrid identity solutions, including SSO, Conditional Access, and MFA policies.
- Configured and managed networking gateways, DNS, load balancers, and virtual cloud networks.
- Coordinated O365 migrations for 2000 users, leading to a 10% productivity increase.
- Oversaw migration and administration of O365 environments.
- Ensures process and procedures are followed and creates process documentation for new services.
- Ensures Business Unit needs are met within agreed-upon timelines.
- Participates in CAB process for infrastructure changes.
- Works closely with vendor escalations as required.
- Ensures system security and access policies are followed and maintained.
- Experience in Windows and Network security practices and strategies.
- Administered VMware vSphere and oVirt environments, supporting critical applications.
- Implemented and configured KVM hypervisors with libvirt and Open vSwitch for network optimization.
- Migrated 1000+ VMware Windows VMs to Red Hat KVM.
- Strong knowledge of Microsoft Windows Server in Hyper-V virtualized environments.
- Collaborated with development teams to containerize workloads on KVM hosts.
- Performed VMware administration tasks, including VMotion, Storage VMotion, HA, and DRS.
- Deployed and managed Nutanix AHV clusters and HCI solutions to enhance performance and simplify operations.
- Migrated servers to XenCenter and configured Citrix role servers.
- Conducted P2V migrations from physical servers to both VMware and KVM virtual environments.
- Monitoring, configuring, and tuning Linux/Windows VMs for performance improvements.
- Citrix administration and VMware resource optimization.
- OS hardening based on CIS-CAT benchmarks, remediated using Group Policies and LGPO.
- Remediated vulnerabilities based on Rapid7, Qualys, and MVM reports.
- Assisted in a network-wide ransomware recovery effort, restoring services within 24 hours.
- Developed custom PowerShell modules to automate routine tasks, saving ~80 hours/month.
- Created PowerShell scripts for tasks like CPU, Disk, and memory utilization incidents and access provisioning.
- Automated VM deployment processes using Ansible and AWX Tower.
- Implemented Ansible for both Windows/Linux administration, enhancing automation.
- Contributed to projects migrating services to AWS/Azure, enhancing scalability and reliability.
- Configured and managed Azure subscriptions, permissions, and Azure AD (AAD, AAD-DS, Azure AD Connect).
- Provisioned VMs, managed Azure VNETs/Subnets, NICs/NSGs, and availability sets.
- Worked extensively with AWS services (EC2, S3, VPC, ELB, Auto Scaling Groups, Route 53, IAM, CloudTrail, CloudWatch, RDS).
- Managed Oracle Cloud services, enforcing access security via IAM roles, users, and groups.
- Installed and configured Azure Active Directory Domain Services, seamless authentication, and Azure Dashboards.
- Background in supporting highly available systems (e.g., clustering).
- Experience with Windows system management tools and capacity planning philosophies.
- Patched Windows servers and created baselines using SCCM.
- Executed patch management lifecycle company-wide, including SCCM patching.
- Strong understanding of TCP/IP networking, including DNS and DHCP.
- Participates in Critical Incident Response Team escalation calls (P1 and P2).
- Worked on Problem Management tickets (RCCA).
- Masterminded a server consolidation project, reducing physical servers by 25%.
- Managed data center operations with a focus on incident management and remediation.
- Supported Application Services teams as needed.
- Created DevOps organizations, integrated REPOs, and managed access.
- Perform firmware updates, RAID configurations, and hardware replacements for Dell and HP servers.
- Configure and manage Dell OpenManage Enterprise, Secure Connect Gateway, and HP iLO for hardware monitoring and remote diagnostics.

Lumeris HealthCare Inc

Oct 2012 - Jun 2016

Sr. Systems Admin

- Responsible for managing Windows 2106 DNS Servers, Active Directory Services, GPO management and Shavlik and SCCM.
- Implement VMware Horizon VDI with UCS.

- Configure and manage linked clones and manage linked-clone desktops.
- Create new pool as per requirements.
- Manage persistent disks, local-mode desktops, VDI OS image lifecycle, ESX host up gradation and patching using update manager, and patches using Shavlik and SCCM.
- Create Thinapp applications, including IE9, IE10, IE 11, Firefox, and Chrome.
- Configure VLANs in virtual connect manager (adding to ESX and ESXi servers) and VM priorities on CPU and memory resources.
- Administer and migrate virtual machines, Shavlik/Symantec antivirus, and NetApp FAS 2240.
- Implement and support SCCM 2012 and engine ServiceDesk.
- Handle incident, problem, and change management using Orion, Pagerduty, and ServiceDesk.
- Monitor production using Orion, Nagios, Site 24*7, and F5 load balancer.
- Troubleshoot AD (Active Directory) replication, DNS, and DHCP issues.
- Remediate vulnerabilities based on the Vulnerability report.

ITC Infotech

Jun 2011 - Sep 2012

Associate Consultant

- Configured VM priorities on CPU and memory resources, VMware clusters and resource pools, and Cluster Servers.
- Managed virtual machine clones and templates.
- Restored Active Directory objects.
- Troubleshoot AD replication issues.
- Controlled user environment using group policies.
- Supported Exchange Server 2003 and 2007 L2 and L3.
- Installation of Esx, ESXi 4.x.
- Managing ESX Servers with V-center server
- Implementation HA & DRS
- Created and troubleshoot mailbox, distribution list, and public folders.
- Monitored and troubleshoot server using SCOM and OP Manager.
- Mentored peers on VMware administration to handle VMware related issues.
- Installed and configured PROD and QA game servers, databases, web servers.
- Configured High availability for services.
- Troubleshooting network and databases issues.
- Weekly Maintenance and patching servers.
- Respond to Tier 3 customer support technical tickets.
- Respond and resolve monitoring/network operation alerts.
- Taking Care of all users related L1 and L2 issues related to XenApp and VDI.

Karvy ComputerShare, Hyderabad

Jan 2010 - Jun 2011

Associate Consultant

- Configured and maintained Cluster Servers, HP Blade Server, and OP manager application.
- Controlled user environment using group policies.
- Cleaned and defragged Active Directory metadata to improve AD performance.
- Managed Active Directory migration from Windows 2003 to Windows 2008, P2V migrations, patches using WSUS and SMS servers, and roaming and mandatory user profiles.
- Installed server using ILO and virtual server using VSpear.
- Recovered Tombstone objects in Active Directory.
- Managing Active Directory, DHCP, DNS Servers.
- Monitoring, troubleshooting and regular maintenance on servers.
- Coordinated with developers to troubleshoot issues, patching games etc.,
- Configuring RAID, installing OS and updates, and configuring game servers remotely over iDRAC.
- Respond to tickets and resolve issues reported on helpdesk.
- Technical training for new member of staff.

Speck Spatialtech, Hyderabad

Dec 2005 - Dec 2009

Systems & Network Administrator

- Configured Windows 2000, 2003, and XP; Sonic Wall firewall; and GIS and Photogrammetric software.
- Facilitated the decommissioning of obsolete hardware, repurposing 60% for non-critical environments.
- Installed and supported Microsoft, third-party, and tailor-made applications.
- Routed network traffic to different ISPs.
- Handled vendor and asset management.
- Active Directory migration and administration.